

pay it back, it's not really a financial problem. It's a symptom of a spiritual problem. The real problem: a lack of trust in God. If we trust God, He will provide all we need within our income, which leads me to the next principle.

DOES GOD REALLY LOVE US?

Another way that God uses money is to demonstrate that He really does love us. I think of what Jesus said, "What man is there among you, when his son shall ask him for a loaf, will give him a stone? Or if he shall ask for a fish, he will not give him a snake, will he? If you then, being evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more shall your Father who is in heaven give what is good to those who ask Him!" (Matthew 7:9-11) The prerequisites for receiving God's best are:

- (1) Love and trust Him as your personal Saviour.
- (2) Be willing to obey Him.
- (3) Demonstrate this obedience by following His principles.

God is going to bless those who are willing to say, "God, we trust You, and since You know best, maybe we can do without that five-bedroom, three-bath home that we think we need. We're willing to be content with a two-bedroom, one-bath apartment for a while, believing that somewhere down the road, You have exactly the right home that we can afford within our budget."

It boils down to a set of decisions:

- (1) Do you really trust God?
- (2) Are you willing to put that trust into action?
- (3) Are you willing to wait upon God's provision?

A COMMUNICATIONS TOOL

Lastly, God uses money in the lives of any young couple to draw them closer together. In contrast, Satan wants to drive a wedge between a husband and wife. Why? In hopes that the resultant turmoil will drive you away from God. God will bring you closer together if, from the very beginning, you will establish God's Word as your financial guide.